CliftonStrengths® for Students

Welcome to CliftonStrengths for Students, the report that guides you through your unique talents and how you can use those talents to succeed in your role.

We designed this report to make your days easier, bring clarity to your role as a student and help you thrive academically, socially and in your future career.

Use this report to learn about your results and better understand what you naturally do best as a student. Then, go implement the action items into your role responsibilities — starting today.

YOUR TOP FIVE THEMES

1. Competition
Aim for first place so you'll always finish strong.

2. Focus
Set specific goals with timelines to motivate yourself.

3. Positivity
Help others see the humor and positive side of life.

4. Achiever
Bring intensity and effort to the most important areas of your life.

5. Significance
Look for opportunities to do important work where you can help others raise the bar.

Each Theme Fits Into a Leadership Domain

EXECUTING themes help you make things happen.

INFLUENCING themes help you take charge, speak up and make sure others are heard.

RELATIONSHIP BUILDING themes help you build strong relationships that hold a team together.

STRATEGIC THINKING themes help you absorb and analyze information that informs better decisions.

StrengthsFinder® | Copyright © 2000, 2023 Gallup, Inc. All rights reserved.

Your Strongest Future Begins Here



1. **Competition**
2. **Focus**
3. **Positivity**
4. **Achiever**
5. **Significance**

This time in your life is filled with choices, changes and challenges. Being a student requires so much of your time and energy — and no two students have the same experience, which means there must be more than one way to succeed. We know that the best way to build a foundation for success, both as a student and well into the future, is by using your strengths.

Your distinct CliftonStrengths profile sets you apart from every other student. Above is your talent DNA, shown in order based on your responses to the assessment.

Learn About Your Most Powerful Strengths

This report outlines how your natural strengths give you an advantage during your time as a student. But to fully understand your talent DNA, you must know that your top five themes — the ones that shine through in almost everything you do — are the *most powerful*. Take the time to learn more about them.

Discover Practical Ways to Apply Them

Incorporate your strengths into your day-to-day routine: from choosing your class schedule and creating study habits to investing in extracurricular activities and relationships with classmates.

Each theme page includes:

- **How that theme contributes to your success**
- **How that theme could get in the way of your success**
- **Action items that you can implement immediately**

Use Them

You have strengths that are already within you; it's your specific talents, along with how you use them, that gives you your power and edge over others. Regardless of what you're doing in academia and where you're going next, you'll need to truly use and develop your strengths to create long-term and sustainable success.

StrengthsFinder® | Copyright © 2000, 2023 Gallup, Inc. All rights reserved.



INFLUENCING

1. Competition®

You measure your progress against the performance of others. You strive to win first place and revel in contests.

How This Theme Contributes to Your Success

You're motivated to win and succeed in academics and extracurricular activities. You push hard for excellence and always compete against others and yourself. You don't tire easily because the energy of a competition keeps you going. You are constantly comparing yourself to obvious metrics like grades, class rankings, etc., while also creating your own personal winning metrics.

You have intense standards that are hard to meet. You are motivated by the fact that others around you are also striving for good grades, honor roll, student government and more. But you're not just *willing* to compete — you *must* compete. Your sights are set on getting into the best programs, getting the biggest scholarships, finishing a test first or having the best project.

You inspire others, and your tenacity energizes the classroom. Your teachers can rely on the fact that you will always try your hardest. You are not a passive participant in class discussions and care deeply about learning outcomes. In group project settings, you bring others along with you. Your success becomes their success, which your classmates appreciate.

How This Theme Could Get in the Way of Your Success

- Sometimes you focus on winning over learning. You may forget to follow the learning objectives in your attempt to compete and win. Coming in first can be motivating, but it's no longer healthy when you aren't learning or retaining information. Sometimes losing is OK if it means you learned. Failure is an essential part of learning; this is something that is difficult for you to accept.
- Others might not see you as someone who works well with others because you sometimes put a grade or outcome above people. A "win at all costs" mentality can harm relationships, and when it comes to academics, you'll want to have a reliable social network as you look at what's next in your life. Don't jeopardize relationships with classmates or teachers for the sake of winning.
- Your expectations for others may be too high. Not everyone has the same drive to win as you. When you partner with these classmates, try to see their perspectives. You may interpret their noncompetitive behavior as not taking things seriously, when in reality, you may be the one with skewed expectations. This causes you to miss others' individual talents.

StrengthsFinder® | Copyright © 2000, 2023 Gallup, Inc. All rights reserved.

ACTION ITEMS

How to Apply Competition as a Student

This theme gives you an edge — here's how you can use it.

- ☐ **Measure your performance in a new way.** In addition to grades, set learning goals and focus on retaining information. Doing this can help you concentrate on acquiring knowledge rather than just getting good grades. Think about what subjects and topics you want to be an expert in and how you will measure that. Learning more today means winning more tomorrow.
- ☐ **Prevent competition fatigue by prioritizing your involvement.** Make a list of everything you're currently involved in and everything you want to be involved in. You bring intense energy to everything you do, so make sure you focus on where you really want to win and consider saying no to the tasks, classes or extracurricular activities that don't contribute to your overall goals.
- ☐ **Set the standard for excellence in group projects.** With your group members' help, set ambitious goals. Ask others what success looks like to them to create metrics and goals that everyone will be proud of. Let your classmates know how invested you are in the project and what the outcomes mean to you. Aligning on outcomes early will be important to the group's success.
- ☐ **Decide who needs to know about your successes.** Part of succeeding means sharing your wins with others, which motivates you as you track your progress and helps you set challenging goals for your future. Break down these goals into smaller, more achievable ones. Communicate to someone you admire that you are competing against yourself.

Reflect to Plan for Action

What's a recent win you're proud of? Reflect on what made it successful.	Whom can you talk to when you're disappointed with a loss? Invest in that relationship.

StrengthsFinder | Copyright © 2000, 2023 Gallup, Inc. All rights reserved.



EXECUTING

2. Focus®

You can take a direction, follow through and make the corrections necessary to stay on track. You prioritize, then act.

How This Theme Contributes to Your Success

Things don't easily distract you. You are a great listener in class and can walk away from conversations with clear directives and an in-depth understanding of the goal. You can also explain these things to a group or classmate clearly and concisely. Whatever you start — a conversation, an assignment, a meeting — you stay focused on the present task.

When it comes to the future, you have a strategy in place to achieve your goals. While you may not know the specifics of what you want to do, chances are you have a strong sense of direction, especially as you continue through school. You intentionally select jobs, classes, networking relationships and areas of study based on a clear internal purpose and priorities for your future.

You naturally work at a higher efficiency for extended periods of time. This means you can keep a group project moving toward the end while concentrating on the present work. When it's time to do intense research, long writing or strenuous studying, you can block out the distractions of both the physical setting you're in and the people around you.

How This Theme Could Get in the Way of Your Success

- Balancing an extensive workload might overwhelm you. Because you'd prefer to focus on one task at a time, having many competing priorities can get challenging to manage. When multiple projects, teachers and tasks need your attention simultaneously, it becomes more difficult for you to get into a deep, productive flow.
- Without specific learning goals, you're unsure where to direct your energy. While you long to get things done, unclear directives and busy work without a connection to a larger goal feel like wasted effort. However, these types of projects are often out of your control. You may lose motivation to work on things designed to lack a logical sequence, system or plan.
- You might be impatient with obstacles, tangents or things slowing down the class. You could get frustrated when a classmate gets the teacher off the subject or a member of a club you're in tells off-topic stories during a meeting. Don't overlook that these seemingly irrelevant conversations are often important in relationship-building; not everything leads directly to an outcome.

StrengthsFinder® | Copyright © 2000, 2023 Gallup, Inc. All rights reserved.

ACTION ITEMS

How to Apply Focus as a Student

This theme gives you an edge — here's how you can use it.

- ☐ **Reprioritize your responsibilities throughout the day.** You might have to change your initial plans as you face competing priorities. For instance, maybe you had intended to spend time studying for an exam, but now your group must meet for a project. Take a moment to rearrange your day to concentrate on the most important task, even if it's not what you expected.
- ☐ **Share goals and expectations out loud when working in a group.** While others are excited to talk about where to start, you can start by helping everyone focus on the outcome. Talk about the goal, what to do to get there and where the group could deviate from the main objective. This mindset will help your group avoid wasting time.
- ☐ **Put time on your calendar or to-do list to only concentrate on your most important work.** Protect this time. Think about when you do your best work, when your attention is the strongest and when you need a break. Then schedule your days and routines to use the times when you have the most energy to get things done.
- ☐ **Intentionally build strong relationships.** Be comfortable talking about things that might have nothing to do with your current assignment, project or task. Your talents make you very task-focused, which helps a lot with your academics. But learning how to use that same desire for outcomes in your relationships is beneficial. Your friendships will be better because of it.

Reflect to Plan for Action

What has your attention right now? Does it match your academic or social priorities?	How can you reprioritize your current tasks to help meet your long-term goals?

StrengthsFinder | Copyright © 2000, 2023 Gallup, Inc. All rights reserved.



RELATIONSHIP BUILDING

3. Positivity®

You have contagious enthusiasm. You are upbeat and can get others excited about what they are going to do.

How This Theme Contributes to Your Success

You are a generally optimistic person who easily encourages others with your contagious energy. Your classmates, teachers and friends benefit from your joyful demeanor and positive outlook on life. Whether they got a lower grade than they expected or they're trying to enroll in a class that's full, you are the one they rely on to help them deal with frustrating experiences.

When negativity upsets others, your positive mood can help improve the atmosphere. For instance, if there's an assignment that others are hesitant to begin or a group project that becomes overwhelming, you naturally see the points of commonality and help shift the general attitude. Where others only see problems, you help point out possible solutions.

You influence others by telling jokes and stories and building carefree connections. When it's time for you to take a leadership position, others are willing and excited to follow you because they know you set such a positive tone and will keep spirits high throughout a project until you reach the goal. You are an asset to any team because of how you develop relationships.

How This Theme Could Get in the Way of Your Success

- When classmates or friends share their struggles, you often point out what's going well, trying to help them see the optimistic side of things. People need to be able to freely share their feelings and frustrations. Some struggles have serious or unfortunate consequences — missed deadlines, failed tests, lost scholarships — and dismissing them can cause others to see you as unrealistic.
- You might not feel as energized when you are taking a boring or uneventful class that doesn't allow you the freedom to interact with others. Or, when learning subjects are complicated and intense without any lighthearted conversation, you might struggle to stay focused on the work you are doing.
- You may take constructive criticism on a project, assignment or idea too personally. Because of your natural focus on what's right and positive, spending too much time focusing on what's wrong or needs fixing can feel uncomfortable. While you know that feedback is supposed to help, it may be hard for you to accept.

StrengthsFinder® | Copyright © 2000, 2023 Gallup, Inc. All rights reserved.

ACTION ITEMS

How to Apply Positivity as a Student

This theme gives you an edge — here's how you can use it.

- ☐ **Set clear and achievable goals for your school year.** Use your optimistic outlook to consider which big goals you want to achieve. Break them into more specific objectives. Incorporate these smaller objectives into your weekly routine because as you meet them, your positive attitude will thrive knowing you're on your way to success.
- ☐ **Ask others how you can help them.** Do they need you to listen instead of talk? Could they use your advice? Do they need a positive distraction from something difficult? Allowing classmates and friends to share how they need you to support them will benefit your relationships and allow you to influence them encouragingly — even if it's not exactly how you'd like to do it.
- ☐ **Reflect on your successes and struggles so far.** Naturally, you may stop to reflect on everything that has gone well in your life up until now. But consider the important lessons you can learn from the struggles. Look at the good and the bad together. You will learn the most when you consider the details of both.
- ☐ **Celebrate achievements with others.** Nobody is better at celebrating others' successes than you are. Point out wins, share recognition, or organize a celebration for a passed exam or excellent group project grade. Encouraging others to celebrate their academic successes will bring excitement to otherwise average days as a student.

Reflect to Plan for Action

What situations have benefited from your contagious energy in the past week?	What lessons have you learned from last year's failures and successes?

StrengthsFinder® | Copyright © 2000, 2023 Gallup, Inc. All rights reserved.



EXECUTING

4. Achiever®

You work hard and possess a great deal of stamina. You take immense satisfaction in being busy and productive.

How This Theme Contributes to Your Success

You have a constant need for attainment. Whether it's in your classwork, extracurricular activities or other academic affairs, you are looking for the next goal to complete. You try to start assignments right away to stay ahead of your to-do list. You push yourself to the next level and want others to push themselves too.

In a group setting, you bring the motivation to get things done. You don't know what it means to be stagnant or stalled when completing work, and you inspire others to get things done too. Your preference is to work with other students who enjoy a challenge, work hard and are ready to accomplish big things.

A strong work ethic, intense busyness and continuous improvement are the hallmarks of your academic career. Regardless of how many classes you're in, what job (or jobs) you've picked up or your involvement in other activities, you stay focused on your goals. You don't just work hard to work hard; you do more because you know it will help you succeed long after you graduate.

How This Theme Could Get in the Way of Your Success

- Because you're motivated to get things done quickly and efficiently, others who can't keep up with you might start to frustrate you. Whether that is another student, a teacher or the pace of a class, you may get annoyed and have a hard time applying yourself when you don't feel challenged enough.
- You run the risk of being over-involved. Your energy to complete tasks and achieve new goals never dwindles, and you won't let yourself fail either. This means you'll likely sacrifice your physical and mental wellbeing, or even relationships, to meet your academic goals and accomplish all you've set out to do.
- You often move on to the next task, assignment or project without considering the one you just finished. You may be missing valuable information on what went well, what could have gone better, or what you or the group needs to replicate next time. Stopping to celebrate with the group or even by yourself will help you create better strategies and be more successful overall.

StrengthsFinder® | Copyright © 2000, 2023 Gallup, Inc. All rights reserved.

ACTION ITEMS

How to Apply Achiever as a Student

This theme gives you an edge — here's how you can use it.

- ☐ **Prioritize your task list so you know where to begin.** Everything on your list feels equally important to you, so it's essential to organize based on due date, classroom expectations and your goals. At the beginning of each week, consider your to-do list and upcoming projects. Listing out your current workload, tasks and goals will help you better rank and complete them.
- ☐ **Designate tasks when working on a group project.** Your desire to get things done helps you make sure that no task or goal goes unaccounted for. Share your inspiration and objectives for every project outcome, and then make sure your classmates are aligned on who is doing what.
- ☐ **Describe your major goals to a teacher, mentor or friend.** You are always thinking about what's next — whether it's more school or your future career — so share the details of your plans with someone you trust. Ask them to give you their feedback and work with you in areas where you need help. And don't forget to communicate your wins with someone you trust!
- ☐ **Celebrate and reflect on a recent individual or group success.** Think about what led to that accomplishment, how you contributed to it and how you can replicate it in the future. Consider what you can do differently or better next time. The more you learn about your processes as a student, the easier it will be to use your successful patterns in your future career.

Reflect to Plan for Action

What are the most important steps for you to take to achieve a major goal?	How can you rest or reset when school or life gets really busy?

StrengthsFinder | Copyright © 2000, 2023 Gallup, Inc. All rights reserved.



INFLUENCING

5. Significance®

You want to make a big impact. You are independent and prioritize projects based on how much influence they will have on your organization or people around you.

How This Theme Contributes to Your Success

Legacy is important to you. You are most passionate and engaged when you see the influence your projects have and when you know others will remember you. This means you work hard in your classes, clubs or extracurricular activities to ensure that you are positively influencing those around you. You want to work on admirable things that make a difference.

You strive to build credibility and impressive skills. When classmates or teachers hear your name, they likely think of your reputation for being hardworking and motivated. You enjoy it when others recognize you for your individual contributions to a group project or class discussion. That acknowledgment from teachers or classmates is very meaningful to you.

Chances are, you are more likely to enjoy independent work than group projects. This is because you can control the outcomes and the influence to reflect your legacy and goals. In group settings, you motivate others to raise their standards on what is considered high performance or success. You love setting a precedent for excellence.

How This Theme Could Get in the Way of Your Success

- You may struggle to stay engaged without a strong purpose or a chance to stand out. If a class feels too standard or doesn't leave room for individual success, you may not thrive. Unfortunately, not every class you take will allow you the freedom to have the noticeable effect you want, and some may be focused on group performance instead of individual achievement.
- Others may perceive you as a showoff because you want to learn only important skills and pursue only visible roles. From the outside, it might look like you're not open to supporting roles in a group project or like you think you have nothing to learn from your classmates. This could harm your classroom relationships, damaging the reputation you work hard to protect.
- You may discredit or dismiss others' value if you focus too much on your own goals. You have a powerful presence in a classroom; if you forget to turn that toward others, you risk ignoring the talent and greatness of those around you. You can be intimidating to other classmates, so try to be aware of how they perceive you.

StrengthsFinder® | Copyright © 2000, 2023 Gallup, Inc. All rights reserved.

ACTION ITEMS

How to Apply Significance as a Student

This theme gives you an edge — here's how you can use it.

- ☐ **Get involved in a group that matches your values.** As you build your legacy as a student, decide how you want others to remember you. What groups do you want to align yourself with? What are you passionate about? Join those groups and help them set bigger goals, and then invest your time and energy in supporting their meaningful work.
- ☐ **Give others recognition.** Because you like being recognized for your contributions, you know how inspiring it is to get recognition. Notice your classmates' talents and contributions, and share them in a specific, timely and genuine way. This will help shape your reputation as a leader while filling your internal desire for recognition. Sometimes recognizing others feels just as good.
- ☐ **List out your goals.** Use this list when making decisions that will influence your future. Then consider the people you want around you when you accomplish those goals. Whom can you share them with, and whose recognition do you value most? Maybe a mentor, parent, friend or teacher — let them know what you want to do, and keep them updated on your progress.
- ☐ **Strategically plan your classwork.** As you look at your required classes and the electives that interest you, consider how these subjects will energize you. If you must take some uneventful classes, try pairing them with others that will challenge you, allow you to succeed in front of people and require a lot of individual involvement.

Reflect to Plan for Action

What is the best recognition you have ever received?	How do you want others to remember you after completing your time as a student?

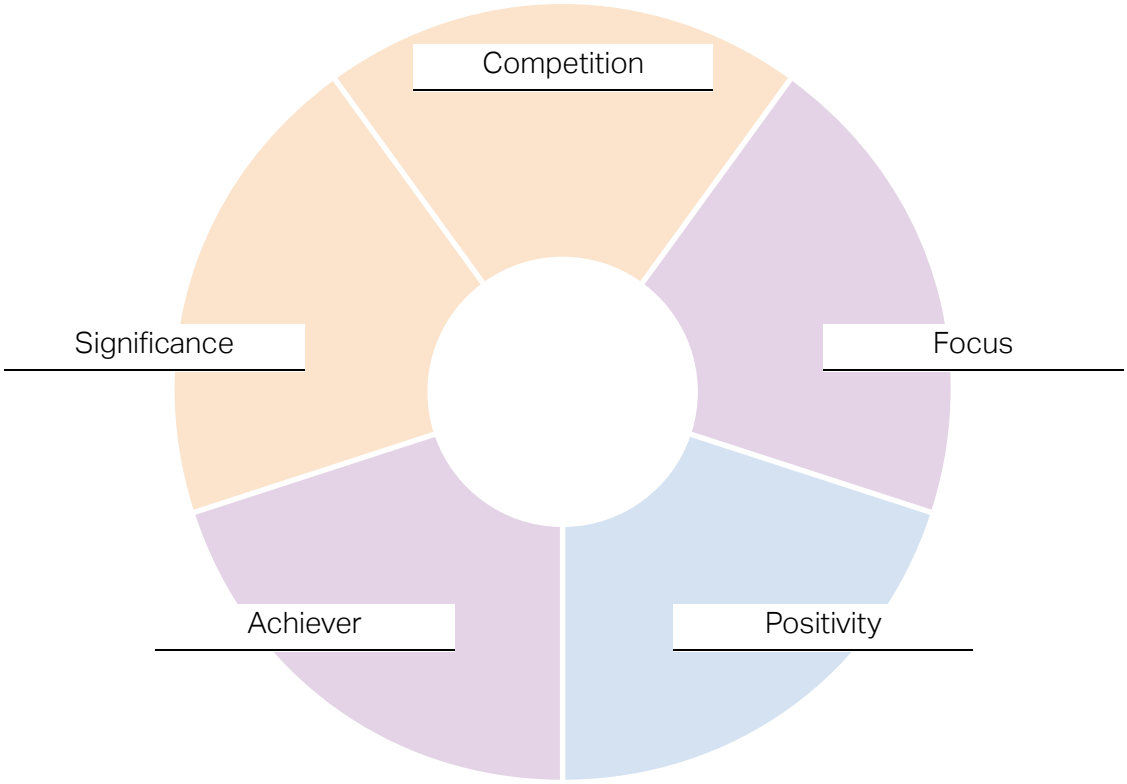
StrengthsFinder | Copyright © 2000, 2023 Gallup, Inc. All rights reserved.

Accomplish Your Goals

There's no "one right way" to succeed as a student. You'll get the best results by building on who you already are. But talents don't turn into strengths right away; you must continually aim them at your goals and the outcomes you desire most.

With a commitment to using your strengths, this report becomes the first step you take on the road to success selling.

Write your most meaningful goal in the center of the circle. Next, think about the themes you can use to achieve this goal to help you answer the questions below.



How will you use your strengths to reach this goal?

How will you know you have been successful?

StrengthsFinder | Copyright © 2000, 2023 Gallup, Inc. All rights reserved.

COPYRIGHT STANDARDS

This document contains proprietary research, copyrighted and trademarked materials of Gallup, Inc. Accordingly, international and domestic laws and penalties guaranteeing patent, copyright, trademark and trade secret protection safeguard the ideas, concepts and recommendations related within this document.

The materials contained in this document and/or the document itself may be downloaded and/or copied provided that all copies retain the copyright, trademark and any other proprietary notices contained on the materials and/or document. No changes may be made to this document without the express written permission of Gallup, Inc.

Any reference whatsoever to this document, in whole or in part, on any webpage must provide a link back to the original document in its entirety. Except as expressly provided herein, the transmission of this material shall not be construed to grant a license of any type under any patents, copyright or trademarks owned or controlled by Gallup, Inc.

Gallup®, CliftonStrengths®, Clifton StrengthsFinder®, StrengthsFinder® and each of the 34 strengths theme names are trademarks of Gallup, Inc. All rights reserved. All other trademarks and copyrights are the property of their respective owners.